noteworthy sally is when in the 1930s the UK authorities unlawfully detained a Russian ship carrying arms for the elected republican government in Spain, which was facing a fascist rebellion. Pritt spent a fruitless day before the Chief Justice of Gibraltar (known to be a fascist sympathizer) trying to get the ship released. When the judge rose at the end of the day, Pritt remained seated:

> CJ: Mr Pritt, I am leaving the court.
> DNP: I am very pleased to hear it.
> CJ: It is customary, Mr Pritt, for counsel to rise as a mark of respect.
> DNP: That is why I am remaining seated.

On the occasion of D.N. Pritt's defence of Bhagat Singh, however, he did not fare so well. The judges' attitude towards Pritt ranged from apoplectic outrage to haughty contempt. Pritt argued that the reasons given for the ordinance by Lord Irwin could not in law be justified. At the end, in *Bhagat Singh v. The Kings Emperor 1931*, without even calling upon the government lawyer to respond, Lord Dunedin handed down a one-and-a-half-page judgment in which he ruled that 'although the Governor-General thought fit to expound the reasons which induced him to promulgate this Ordinance, this was not in their Lordships opinion incumbent on him as a matter of law'. This was quite simply wrong. Even at the best of times, it would have been a proposition of dubious legal validity to say that the giving of reasons for an emergency ordinance was not even necessary. Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev and Rajguru mounted the gallows the following month on 23 March 1931. When they did so, they acquired the status of martyrdom.

In this way, Bhagat Singh differed once again from Gandhi in his belief in 'martyrdom'. For him, it was the ultimate sacrifice to be prepared to lay down one's life for a just cause. When he was just eight years old, Bhagat Singh was witness to the First Lahore Conspiracy Case of 1915. This is when on 17 November 1915, seven Ghadar martyrs were executed inside Lahore Prison. One of these was the nineteen-year-old Kartar Singh Sarabha, whose photograph Bhagat Singh carried in his pocket. Bhagat